

Visas for studying in New Zealand

There are many different visas that let you study in New Zealand. You can go to school, take a short course, study for longer or do other training.

Note

International students are strongly encouraged to apply 3 months before their intended travel date.

Visas that allow you to study

There are a range of visas you can apply for to study in New Zealand.

You do not need a visa to study in New Zealand if you are an Australian citizen.

Temporary visas and NZeTA

If you have a visitor visa, work visa or a New Zealand Electronic Travel Authority (NZeTA), you can study up to 3 months in any 12-month period.

School-aged children who have visitor visas can study for up to 3 months in any calendar year.

Note

If children are going to be studying for more than 2 weeks, their education provider must be a signatory to the Education (Pastoral Care of Tertiary and International Learners) Code of Practice 2021.

Find out if an education provider is a signatory, and how the code protects international students.

[Wellbeing and safety for international learners — NZQA](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/https://www2.nzqa.govt.nz/tertiary/the-code/the-code-for-learners/the-code-for-international-school-learners/)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/https://www2.nzqa.govt.nz/tertiary/the-code/the-code-for-learners/the-code-for-international-school-learners/>)

[Visitor Visa](https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/visitor-visa) (<https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/visitor-visa>)

[New Zealand Electronic Travel Authority \(NZeTA\)](https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/new-zealand-electronic-travel-authority-nzeta)

(<https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/new-zealand-electronic-travel-authority-nzeta>)

Working holiday visas

If you are aged 18 to 30, or 18 to 35 in a select few countries, and a citizen of a country that has a working holiday agreement with New Zealand, you can apply for a working holiday visa.

On a working holiday visa, you can study 1 or more [courses](#) for up to 6 months in New Zealand. For example, you could study English, do a Study Abroad programme, or a short training course.

You must be coming mainly to holiday — study should be a secondary intention.

[Who can apply for a working holiday visa](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/work/working-holiday-visas/who-can-apply-for-a-working-holiday-visa/)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/work/working-holiday-visas/who-can-apply-for-a-working-holiday-visa/>)

Student visas

If you want to study for more than 3 months in New Zealand, you will need an offer of place from a New Zealand education provider to apply for a student visa.

Students younger than 10

We only give student visas to international students younger than 10 if they will be living in New Zealand with their legal guardian or in an approved school hostel.

Parents and legal guardians of children studying in New Zealand can visit New Zealand to live with and care for their children.

[Guardian Visitor Visa \(https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/guardian-of-a-student-visitor-visa\)](https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/guardian-of-a-student-visitor-visa)

Students younger than 18

International students who are younger than 18 must provide a statement from their education provider confirming their accommodation complies with the Education (Pastoral Care of Tertiary and International Learners) Code of Practice 2021.

[Offering a place to a student
\(https://www.immigration.govt.nz/study/for-education-providers/offering-a-place-to-a-student/\)](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/study/for-education-providers/offering-a-place-to-a-student/)

Explore visa options

Visa filter tool

Use the visa filter tool to help you choose a visa that fits your situation.

[Visas \(https://www.immigration.govt.nz/visas/\)](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/visas/)

Visa lookup

You can find a visa directly from the 'Visa lookup' search field found in the footer on each page.

Simply start to type a visa name or key word such as 'student' and a list of visas that match your search will appear. You can then select the visa you would like to view.

Customising information on a visa page

If you are looking at a visa page online, entering your details on the page will display information specific to someone from your country.

List of student visas

Explore the following student visas to find one that could suit your situation.

Fee Paying Student Visa

The most common student visa for international students is the Fee Paying Student Visa. With this visa you can study full-time in New Zealand up to 4 years. You will need to pay the full cost of your courses and enrol with an approved education provider.

[Fee Paying Student Visa \(https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/fee-paying-student-visa\)](https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/fee-paying-student-visa)

Pathway Student Visa

You may be able to study full-time up to 3 courses, one after the other, on a single student visa for up to 5 years. The visa is only available for study with approved Pathway Education Providers and for some courses of study.

[Pathway Student Visa information](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/study/study-visas/pathway-student-visa-information/)

[\(https://www.immigration.govt.nz/study/study-visas/pathway-student-visa-information/\)](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/study/study-visas/pathway-student-visa-information/)

[Pathway Student Visa \(https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/pathway-student-visa\)](https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/pathway-student-visa)

Dependent Child Student Visa

If you have an appropriate work or student visa, you can apply for this visa to bring your dependent children aged 19 and younger to study as domestic students at a New Zealand primary or secondary school.

[Dependent Child Student Visa \(https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/dependent-child-student-visa\)](https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/dependent-child-student-visa)

Exchange Student Visa

If you have been accepted into an approved student exchange scheme and are outside New Zealand, you can apply for this visa to study full-time up to 4 years.

[Exchange Student Visa \(https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/exchange-student-visa\)](https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/exchange-student-visa)

English Language Student Visa

Apply for this visa to study an English language course full-time in New Zealand. You will need to pay the full cost of your courses and enrol with an approved education provider.

[English Language Student Visa \(https://www.immigration.govt.nz/visas/english-language-student-visa/\)](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/visas/english-language-student-visa/)

Vocational Trainee Student Visa

Apply for this visa if you are a trainee who has been awarded a New Zealand Short Term Training Scholarship by Manaaki New Zealand Scholarships, or you are a nautical student.

[Vocational Trainee Student Visa \(https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/vocational-trainee-student-visa\)](https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/vocational-trainee-student-visa)

NZ Government Scholarship Student Visa

If you are funded by a New Zealand scholarship administered by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs and Trade (MFAT) or Education New Zealand, you can apply for this visa to study full-time up to 4 years.

[NZ Government Scholarship Student Visa](https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/mfat-funded-nz-scholarship-student-visa)

(<https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/mfat-funded-nz-scholarship-student-visa>)

Foreign Government Supported Student Visa

If you have a foreign government loan or scholarship, you can apply for this visa to study full-time in New Zealand for up to 4 years.

[Foreign Government Supported Student Visa](https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/foreign-government-supported-student-visa)

(<https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/foreign-government-supported-student-visa>)

Trafficking Child Victim Student Visa

With this visa, a child who the New Zealand Police believes to be a victim of people trafficking can study as a domestic student at a New Zealand primary or secondary school. They must be aged 17 or younger and in New Zealand.

[Trafficking Child Victim Student Visa](https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/trafficking-child-victim-student-visa)

(<https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/trafficking-child-victim-student-visa>)

Applying for a student visa

1

Research student visas and find the one that works best

There are a few visa options for people who want to study in New Zealand. Each visa option for studying here has different requirements.

Read through the visa requirements of the student visa options to find out which option is the best visa based on your circumstances and intended study plans.

[Explore student visas](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/study/study-visas/visas-for-studying-in-new-zealand/#e6532)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/study/study-visas/visas-for-studying-in-new-zealand/#e6532>)

2

Enrol with your education provider

When you have decided what subject you want to study and where, you must apply for your place to study with that education provider.

Application times vary depending on the education provider, so it is best to look at their website to find out about their application process.

When you are accepted by an education provider, they will give you an 'offer of place'. You will need this offer to apply for your student visa.

3

Apply for your student visa

When you have been accepted for your programme of study in New Zealand, you can apply for a student visa.

Before you apply, you will need to make sure that you have all the required documents. These include the offer of place from your education provider, evidence of your health and character, and evidence that you have enough funds to support yourself during your stay.

We recommend applying for a student visa 3 months in advance of your intended travel, if possible. There is no deadline for your application, but you should allow at least 8 weeks for visa processing.

If you already have a student visa but intend to stay in New Zealand for longer, you need to make sure that you apply for a further visa at least 4 weeks before your current visa expires.

[Applying online](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/applying-for-a-visa/applying-online/)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/applying-for-a-visa/applying-online/>)

Immigration advice and help

If you receive immigration advice on applying for your student visa, or someone has helped you by explaining, translating or recording information on the form, you must declare this in your application and the person must complete the Student Visa Declaration Form.

To give immigration advice, people must be licensed to do so, or exempt from licensing. Education agents who are outside New Zealand, advising on student visas only, are exempt. Even if they are legally able to provide you with immigration advice, they must be declared in the visa application.

[Getting immigration advice](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/applying-for-a-visa/getting-immigration-advice/)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/applying-for-a-visa/getting-immigration-advice/>)

[!\[\]\(d8ab143e904bfa3467271eec5af75a9b_img.jpg\) Student Visa Declaration Form \(INZ 1226\) \(PDF, 382 KB\)](#)
(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/assets/inz/documents/forms-and-guides/inz1226.pdf>)

When you have your student visa

Getting ready

The Think New website has information to help you plan your trip to New Zealand, and make sure you know how things work here.

[Naumai NZ — Think New, New Zealand Education](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/https://www.naumainz.studywithnewzealand.govt.nz/)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/https://www.naumainz.studywithnewzealand.govt.nz/>)

Arriving in New Zealand

There is also information on this website and the Think New website about the documents you will need when you get here, and what it is like to live in New Zealand.

[Before you leave — Live and Work New Zealand](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/https://www.live-work.immigration.govt.nz/move-to-new-zealand/before-you-leave)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/https://www.live-work.immigration.govt.nz/move-to-new-zealand/before-you-leave>)

[Living in New Zealand — Think New, New Zealand Education](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/https://www.studywithnewzealand.govt.nz/en/why-new-zealand/living-in-new-zealand)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/https://www.studywithnewzealand.govt.nz/en/why-new-zealand/living-in-new-zealand>)

You may be allowed to work while you are on a student visa in New Zealand, this depends on the conditions of your visa.

[Working on a student visa](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/study/once-you-have-a-student-visa/working-on-a-student-visa/)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/study/once-you-have-a-student-visa/working-on-a-student-visa/>)

Education sector updates

Stay informed with Immigration news and updates for the education sector.

[Subscribe to receive education sector updates](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/https://customer.immigration.govt.nz/forms/yv7vt_qxzk64t9mh13cqxt5yfs0c3ldyg022z8lclcdjknmd49fz8v2spr7j)

(https://www.immigration.govt.nz/https://customer.immigration.govt.nz/forms/yv7vt_qxzk64t9mh13cqxt5yfs0c3ldyg022z8lclcdjknmd49fz8v2spr7j)

[Register to receive information about job and study opportunities, choosing the right visa and more](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/https://customer.immigration.govt.nz/forms/8mwtvt027z2433lt13b1mx0vmn09j6xdbw84zrl0rzbjknmd4977lmp9zsj)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/https://customer.immigration.govt.nz/forms/8mwtvt027z2433lt13b1mx0vmn09j6xdbw84zrl0rzbjknmd4977lmp9zsj>)

When you do not need a student visa

You do not need a student visa to study in New Zealand, if you are:

- a New Zealand or Australian citizen
- studying a short course that is less than 3 months, and you already have a visitor, work or student visa.